

DESIGN.md — CleanPix / BG Remover Visual Design System

Source of truth: uploaded UI reference image (landing page, sign-in, dashboard).

This document is the single design contract for building the entire product. Do not deviate from the tokens, components, and rules defined here without updating this file first.

1. Design Vision

CleanPix is a **dark, premium, AI-native SaaS product**. The visual language is built around the idea of "magic happening in the dark" — a near-black canvas punctuated by glowing blue-to-purple light, translucent glass cards, and soft ambient orbs that imply depth and computation happening beneath the surface. The UI should feel like a control panel from a near-future creative studio: minimal chrome, generous negative space, one confident focal visual per screen (the before/after image, the upload dropzone, the dashboard preview grid), and light used deliberately — as a way to draw the eye to the single most important action.

Every screen follows the same rhythm: **dark base** → **glass surface** → **gradient accent** → **glow**. Nothing is flat; nothing is loud. Contrast comes from luminosity, not saturation.

2. Brand Personality

The product must feel:

Trait	How it's expressed visually
Premium	Deep navy-black palette, generous spacing, no clutter, subtle glass blur
Modern	Rounded geometry, sans-serif type, flat iconography with soft glow
AI Powered	Gradient "spark" badges, glowing orbs, animated blobs, soft neon accents
Fast	Lightning-bolt iconography, short confident copy, snappy button states
Trustworthy	Consistent spacing/alignment, muted secondary text, clear hierarchy
Futuristic	Glassmorphism, gradient meshes, blurred background orbs, thin glowing borders
Creative	Playful hand-drawn accent doodles ("Same image, new possibilities!"), color gradients on key CTAs

3. Color Palette

Core tokens (HEX)

Token	Hex	Usage
Primary	#4F7CFF	Primary buttons, links, active nav state, icon backgrounds
Secondary	#8B5CF6	Gradient partner to primary, secondary accents, crown/pro highlights
Accent (Cyan)	#22D3EE	Gradient highlight, "in Seconds" headline text, hover glows
Background (Base)	#0A0B1E	App shell / page background
Background (Deep)	#05060F	Darkest corners, blob shadow base
Surface / Card	#131A3A ($\approx \text{rgba}(19, 26, 58, 0.75)$)	Cards, sidebar, form panels — always with slight transparency + blur
Surface Elevated	#1B2350	Hovered/active card state, dropdown, input fields
Border (Subtle)	$\text{rgba}(255, 255, 255, 0.08)$	Card outlines, dividers
Border (Glow)	$\text{rgba}(79, 124, 255, 0.45)$	Focused inputs, active nav underline, highlighted card outline
Text Primary	#F8FAFC	Headlines, primary body copy
Text Secondary	#94A3B8	Descriptions, placeholder text, meta labels
Text Muted	#64748B	Timestamps, helper text, disabled states
Success	#22C55E	"Background Removed!" check badge
Warning / Pro	#F5B301	Crown icon, "Go Pro" highlight accents

Gradient definitions

Name	Stops	Angle	Usage
Brand Gradient (Primary CTA)	#4F7CFF → #8B5CF6	90deg / left→right	"Get Started", "Sign In", "Upgrade" buttons, logo mark
Headline Gradient	#4F7CFF → #22D3EE	90deg	"in Seconds" hero text, key emphasized words
Ambient Blob Gradient A	#4F7CFF → transparent (radial)	—	Top-left / bottom-right background orbs
Ambient Blob Gradient B	#8B5CF6 → transparent (radial)	—	Secondary background orbs, layered behind cards
Card Sheen (subtle)	$\text{rgba}(255, 255, 255, 0.04)$ → transparent	135deg	Top-edge highlight on glass cards
Pro/Crown Gradient	#F5B301 → #F97316	90deg	Crown icon fill only, used sparingly

Background composition rule: the base is always a solid near-black (#0A0B1E), with 2–4 large, soft, low-opacity radial-gradient "blobs" (blue and purple) positioned at corners and edges, blurred heavily (60–120px blur equivalent), opacity 15–35%. Never let a blob touch full saturation — they are ambient light, not shapes.

4. Typography

Role	Font	Weight	Size (desktop)	Line height
Heading Font	Sora	700–800	H1: 56–64px / H2: 36–40px / H3: 24–28px	1.1–1.2
Body Font	Inter	400–500	Body: 16px / Small: 14px / Micro: 12px	1.5–1.6
Buttons/Labels	Inter	600	14–16px	1.2
Numeric/Stats	Inter (tabular nums)	700	20–28px	1.1

Weight scale: 400 (body), 500 (emphasized body/labels), 600 (buttons, nav), 700 (subheads), 800 (hero H1 only).

Hierarchy rule: Headlines are near-white (#F8FAFC) with one gradient-highlighted phrase per headline (never the whole line). Body copy always drops to Text Secondary (#94A3B8) — never full white — to preserve depth and let headlines dominate.

5. Layout System

- **Max container width:** 1440px, centered, with 24–32px horizontal gutters on desktop, 16px on mobile.
- **Grid:** 12-column grid on desktop (≥ 1024 px), 4-column on tablet (600–1023px), single column stack on mobile (< 600 px). Gutter: 24px desktop / 16px mobile.
- **Section spacing:** 96–120px vertical padding between major landing-page sections; 64px on tablet; 48px on mobile.
- **Content spacing:** 24px between related content blocks (e.g., headline → subcopy → CTA), 12–16px between tightly related elements (label → input).
- **Card spacing:** 20–24px internal padding for standard cards; 16px gap between cards in a grid; dashboard stat cards use 20px padding with 16px gap.

6. Border Radius System

Element	Radius
Buttons (primary/secondary)	12px (pill-adjacent, not full pill)
Small icon buttons / badges	8px or full pill (999px) for status pills
Cards (feature, dashboard, recent-edit)	16–20px
Large panels / hero image frame	24px
Modals / Sign-in panel	24px
Inputs	12px
Avatar / icon containers	10–12px (squircle), or 999px for profile avatars

Rule: nothing in this system uses sharp (0–4px) corners. The minimum radius anywhere is 8px.

7. Shadow System

Shadow	Spec	Usage
Card Shadow (rest)	0 8px 24px rgba(0,0,0,0.35)	Default elevation for all cards
Card Shadow (hover)	0 12px 32px rgba(0,0,0,0.45), 0 0 1px rgba(79,124,255,0.15)	Card hover lift
Primary Glow	0 0 24px rgba(79,124,255,0.45)	Around primary gradient buttons, active states
Accent Glow (cyan)	0 0 32px rgba(34,211,238,0.35)	Hero image frame, highlighted upload dropzone
Inner Glass Highlight	inset 0 1px 0 rgba(255,255,255,0.06)	Top edge of glass cards for glassmorphism realism
Focus Ring	0 0 0 3px rgba(79,124,255,0.35)	Inputs and interactive elements on focus

Rule: shadows do double duty as both elevation *and* brand glow — dark shadows for depth, colored glows for "AI energy." Never use a pure black drop shadow without pairing it with ambient blob light nearby.

8. Gradient System (applied)

- **Buttons:** `linear-gradient(90deg, #4F7CFF 0%, #8B5CF6 100%)`, text white, glow on hover (box-shadow intensifies + slight `translateY(-1px)`).
- **Hero section:** solid dark background + 2 large radial gradient blobs (blue top-left, purple bottom-right), headline emphasis word in `linear-gradient(90deg, #4F7CFF, #22D3EE)` with `background-clip: text`.
- **Cards:** background is a flat glass tone (`rgba(19,26,58,0.7)`) — gradients are NOT used as card fills, only as accents (icon chips, active nav item, progress rings).
- **Background blobs:** radial gradients, `blur(80px)`, opacity `0.2-0.35`, positioned absolutely, `pointer-events: none`, ideally with a slow drifting animation.
- **Glow effects:** achieved via layered box-shadow, never via a literal bright gradient fill — glows should read as "light emitting from behind," not painted color.

9. Component Design Specifications

9.1 Navbar

- **Layout:** fixed/sticky top, flex row, logo left, nav links center, auth buttons right. Height 72–80px.
- **Padding:** 16px 32px (desktop), 12px 16px (mobile, becomes hamburger menu).
- **Background:** `rgba(10,11,30,0.7)` with backdrop-blur, subtle bottom border (`rgba(255,255,255,0.06)`).
- **Typography:** nav links 14px/500, text secondary; active link #F8FAFC with a thin gradient underline.
- **Buttons:** "Log In" = outline/ghost button (1px solid `rgba(255,255,255,0.15)`, transparent fill, radius 12px); "Get Started" = primary gradient button with glow.

- **Hover:** nav links fade to Text Primary; buttons lift 1px + glow intensifies.
- **Animation:** 150–200ms ease-out on all hover transitions.

9.2 Hero Section

- **Layout:** two-column on desktop (copy left ~45%, visual right ~55%), stacked single-column on mobile (copy first, visual below).
- **Padding:** 120px 32px 80px top section padding.
- **Elements:** eyebrow pill badge (glass, gradient icon + text), H1 with one gradient-highlighted line, secondary paragraph (Text Secondary), primary + secondary CTA side by side, 4-icon trust-feature row below CTAs.
- **Visual:** large rounded image frame (radius 24px) with glow border, floating "Before/After" labels as small glass pills, floating secondary thumbnail stack behind/left of the main frame, a floating success toast card ("Background Removed!") overlapping the bottom-left of the image, small feature-tag chips floating to the right.
- **Animation:** image frame subtly floats (slow vertical translateY loop, 4–6s ease-in-out); before/after slider handle has a pulse/glow to invite interaction; floating cards fade/slide in on load (staggered, 100ms delay each).

9.3 Upload Area (Dropzone)

- **Layout:** centered dashed-border rectangle, icon + primary text + helper text + format/size caption stacked vertically, generous internal padding.
- **Padding:** 48–64px vertical, 32px horizontal.
- **Radius:** 20px.
- **Border:** 2px dashed `rgba(79,124,255,0.35)`; background `rgba(79,124,255,0.05)`.
- **Icon:** upload-cloud icon in a soft circular chip with primary glow.
- **Hover / drag-over:** border brightens to solid glow (`rgba(79,124,255,0.7)`), background tint increases slightly, icon scales 1.05.
- **Typography:** primary label 16px/600 white, helper caption 13px/400 muted.

9.4 Feature Cards (e.g., "Fast Processing", "High-Quality Results")

- **Layout:** icon on top (or left, inline for compact rows) + label below/right, arranged in a horizontal row of 4 under the hero, or grid on other sections.
- **Padding:** 16px (compact inline variant, icon-first row under hero).
- **Radius:** icon chip 10–12px; if wrapped in a card, 16px.
- **Icon style:** flat glyph, single color, inside a rounded square chip with a soft tinted background (`rgba(79,124,255,0.12)`) — not a gradient fill.
- **Typography:** label 13–14px/500, Text Secondary or near-white.
- **Hover:** icon chip glows, text brightens to Text Primary.

9.5 AI Detection / Use-Case Cards (right-side chips: "E-commerce Product Photos", "Social Media Content", etc.)

- **Layout:** horizontal card, icon chip left + label right, single line or two-line wrap.
- **Padding:** 14px 18px.
- **Radius:** 14px.
- **Background:** glass surface, 1px subtle border.

- **Icon chip:** 36–40px square, radius 10px, gradient-tinted background matching the icon's semantic color family (kept muted, not saturated).
- **Hover:** border transitions to glow border color, slight background lightening.

9.6 Social Media Kit / Recent Edits Cards (image thumbnail cards)

- **Layout:** vertical card — checkerboard-background image thumbnail on top (indicates transparency), filename + date below, "Download" button pinned at bottom.
- **Padding:** 12px around content below the image; image itself is edge-to-edge within the card's top radius.
- **Radius:** 16px for the card, inherited 16px 16px 0 0 on the image top corners.
- **Shadow:** standard Card Shadow (rest), lifts on hover.
- **Typography:** filename 13px/500 white, date 11px/400 muted.
- **Button:** small full-width or compact primary/outline button, radius 8–10px.
- **Hover:** card lifts (`translateY(-4px)`), shadow deepens, Download button becomes solid gradient if it was outline.

9.7 Login / Sign-In Form

- **Layout:** two-panel split — left panel is a branded dark panel with logo, welcome headline, and a short benefit checklist (icon + text rows); right panel is the actual form card, centered, max-width ~420px.
- **Padding:** form panel 40px; page split each side ~48px desktop.
- **Radius:** form container 24px; inputs 12px; social buttons 12px.
- **Inputs:** icon-prefixed (mail, lock), background #131A3A, border 1px solid `rgba(255,255,255,0.08)`, focus state uses Focus Ring token + border brightens to primary.
- **Primary button:** full-width gradient button, radius 12px, glow on hover, arrow icon trailing.
- **Divider:** "or continue with" — thin line + centered muted text.
- **Social buttons:** equal-width row of 3, glass background, brand icon + label, subtle hover lift.
- **Footer link:** "Don't have an account? Sign Up" — muted text + gradient/primary-colored link.
- **Animation:** form panel fades/slides in from the right on load; input focus transitions border+ring over 150ms.

9.8 Dashboard (shell)

- **Layout:** persistent left sidebar (fixed width ~260px) + top search/header bar + main content area using a responsive grid (main dropzone spanning ~2/3, right column stacked cards for Credits/Upgrade).
- **Padding:** main content area 24–32px outer padding; grid gap 20–24px.
- **Background:** same base dark as marketing pages — dashboard is NOT a lighter "app mode," it stays on-brand dark.
- **Cards:** Credits card (radius 16px, circular progress ring using primary/accent gradient), Go Pro card (gradient background using Brand Gradient at low opacity or solid gradient with crown icon, radius 16px, stands out as the one saturated card on the page), Quick Actions list (glass card, icon+label rows, 12px vertical rhythm), Usage Stats (mini bar chart + big stat number).
- **Recent Edits grid:** 4-column card grid (responsive to 2-col tablet, 1-col mobile) per section 9.6.
- **Top bar:** search input (glass, icon-prefixed, radius 12px, full flexible width), notification bell (icon button with unread dot badge), user avatar + name + plan label (right-aligned).

9.9 Sidebar

- **Layout:** vertical stack — logo top, nav items (icon + label, one per row), promo card ("Upgrade to Pro") pinned near bottom.
- **Padding:** 20px 16px.
- **Nav item:** 12px 14px padding, radius 10–12px, icon + label horizontally.
- **Active state:** solid Primary-tinted background (`rgba(79, 124, 255, 0.15)`) + primary-colored text/icon + optionally a left accent bar (3px, primary color, radius on the bar itself).
- **Hover (inactive):** background lightens to `rgba(255, 255, 255, 0.04)`.
- **Promo card:** small glass card with crown icon, 1–2 line copy, and a full-width gradient "Go Pro" button.

9.10 Footer

- **Layout:** multi-column (logo+blurb, product links, company links, legal/social) on desktop, accordion/stacked on mobile.
- **Padding:** 64px 32px 32px top, 24px bottom bar.
- **Background:** same base dark, separated from content above by a subtle top border (`rgba(255, 255, 255, 0.06)`), optionally one faint ambient blob bleeding in from a corner.
- **Typography:** column headers 13px/600 uppercase-tracked, Text Secondary; links 14px/400 Text Secondary, hover to Text Primary.
- **Bottom bar:** copyright text (muted, 12px) left, social icons right — icon buttons in small glass circles, radius 999px.

10. Animation Guidelines

- **Hover animations:** 150–200ms ease-out for color/border/background transitions; buttons additionally get `translateY(-1px)` to -2px and shadow/glow intensification; cards lift -4px with deepened shadow.
- **Glow animations:** glow-bearing elements (dropzone border, primary CTA, before/after handle) use a slow pulse keyframe (opacity 0.6 → 1 → 0.6, 2.5–3s ease-in-out infinite) to suggest "always-on AI energy" without being distracting.
- **Loading states:** use a shimmer/skeleton in Surface tones (`#131A3A` → `#1B2350` → `#131A3A` sweep, 1.5s loop) for card placeholders; for active AI processing, prefer a circular gradient spinner (primary→accent gradient ring) over a plain spinner.
- **Page transitions:** simple fade + slight upward slide (opacity 0→1, `translateY(8px→0)`, 300–400ms ease-out) on route/section entry; hero elements stagger in (badge → headline → subcopy → CTAs → visual), 80–120ms stagger delay.
- **Micro-interactions:** checkbox/toggle uses a smooth fill transition; success states (e.g., "Background Removed!") animate in with a scale-bounce (0.9 → 1.02 → 1, 300ms) plus a checkmark draw-in; the before/after slider handle should feel tactile — scale up slightly on:active drag.
- **Background blobs:** continuous slow drift/breathing animation (translate + scale between 1 and 1.05, 10–20s ease-in-out infinite, alternating direction) — imperceptibly slow, never distracting.

11. Responsive Design

Breakpoint	Behavior
Mobile (<600px)	Single column everywhere. Navbar collapses to logo + hamburger. Hero stacks copy-then-visual, CTAs full-width stacked. Feature icon row wraps to 2×2 grid. Dashboard sidebar becomes a bottom tab bar or slide-in drawer. Cards go full-width, grids become 1-column. Font sizes step down ~15–20% (H1 → ~36–40px). Section spacing drops to 48px.
Tablet (600–1023px)	2-column grids where desktop uses 3–4. Hero may stay 2-column but with reduced visual size (~45%) or stack if space is tight. Sidebar can collapse to icon-only rail with tooltips. Section spacing 64px.
Desktop (≥1024px)	Full layout as specified: 2-column hero, 4-column feature grid, persistent full sidebar, multi-column dashboard grid, max content width 1440px.

All breakpoints preserve: dark background, glass cards, gradient CTAs, and glow accents — only density and column count change, never the core visual language.

12. Homepage Structure

1. **Navbar** — logo, nav links (Home/Features/How It Works/Pricing/FAQ), Log In (ghost) + Get Started (gradient) buttons.
2. **Hero** — eyebrow badge, H1 with gradient emphasis, subcopy, dual CTA (Upload Image / Try Demo), format/size caption, 4-item trust-feature row, right-side before/after visual with floating accent elements and a use-case chip list.
3. **Features section** — grid of feature/benefit cards expanding on the hero's trust row.
4. **How It Works** — step-by-step (numbered or icon-led) horizontal or vertical flow.
5. **Use Cases / Social Proof** — cards or logos demonstrating real-world applications.
6. **Pricing** — tiered plan cards, one visually "elevated" (glow border / featured badge) as the recommended plan.
7. **FAQ** — accordion list, glass rows, chevron rotates on expand.
8. **Final CTA band** — full-width gradient-tinted or glow-bordered panel with a single strong call-to-action.
9. **Footer** — as specified in 9.10.

13. Dashboard Design System (summary spec)

- **Shell:** fixed sidebar (nav + promo card) + top bar (search, notifications, profile) + scrollable main content.
- **Main content zones:** (1) primary upload/drop panel, (2) at-a-glance stat cards (Credits ring, Go Pro upsell), (3) Recent Edits card grid with per-item download, (4) Quick Actions list, (5) Usage Stats mini-chart.
- **Visual hierarchy:** the upload dropzone is the largest, most prominent element on the page (echoing the hero on the marketing site); the Go Pro card is the only fully-saturated gradient surface on the page, intentionally drawing the eye as an upsell.
- **Consistency rule:** every dashboard surface reuses the same glass card token, radius scale, and shadow system as the marketing site — the dashboard should feel like "the same product, logged in," never a visual departure.

14. Design Rules

Do

- Use neon blue-to-purple glow effects, applied sparingly and intentionally (CTAs, active states, key visuals).
- Use dark, premium backgrounds (#0A0B1E base) as the constant canvas across every screen, marketing or app.
- Use rounded, modern cards (16px+ radius) with glassmorphism (translucency + subtle blur + thin border).
- Use soft, layered gradients — never a single flat saturated fill for large areas.
- Maintain visual depth via layered shadows, ambient blobs, and glass surfaces stacked on the dark base.
- Keep one clear focal point per screen/section.
- Keep secondary text muted (Text Secondary/Muted tokens) so hierarchy stays obvious.

Avoid

- Flat design with no depth, shadow, or glow — every surface should feel like it's floating on the dark base.
- Harsh, fully-saturated colors covering large areas (gradients stay soft; saturation is reserved for small accents like the Go Pro card or crown icon).
- Heavy, thick, or high-contrast borders — borders are always thin (1px) and low-opacity, brightening only on hover/focus.
- Excessive text or dense paragraphs — favor short headlines, brief subcopy, and iconography over long-form text.
- Inconsistent spacing or radius values — always pull from the scales defined in Sections 5–6, never introduce ad-hoc values.
- Sharp corners anywhere (minimum radius is 8px system-wide).
- Pure black (#000000) or pure white (#FFFFFF) fills — always use the defined near-black/near-white tokens to preserve the product's soft, premium tone.